

Cinerific Android App Work Log - July 24, 2026

Compiled summary for Friday, July 24, 2026 - focus: recovering the Cinerific tablet AVD after a hidden VS Code docked-emulator launch path kept the device headless, continuing destination and detail-screen polish, replacing the gray detail-hero loading placeholder with a black loading scrim, changing detail hero imagery to proportional crop behavior for landscape tablets, iterating the Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings top-banner chrome, adopting the new chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5_landscape asset with crop scaling instead of stretching, preserving the accepted right-side rail treatment, validating Kotlin compilation, refreshing the project snapshot, and generating the latest Cinerific daily worklog artifact.

Generated in continuity with the established Cinerific worklog cadence from July 12, July 14, July 15 Part 1, July 15, July 16, July 18, July 19, July 20, July 22, and July 23: compact opening summary, source-material review, baseline state, goal list, themed work-completed sections, validation, files touched, follow-up context, and output-artifact close. This artifact records the current source state on main through HEAD 6848ccb, plus the refreshed snapshot from this worklog pass, and follows the prior root-level naming, four-page letter layout, footer convention, metadata, and plain-text-readable PDF style.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Reviewed every pre-existing Cinerific worklog PDF at the repository root: July 12, July 14, July 15 Part 1, July 15, July 16, July 18, July 19, July 20, July 22, and July 23.
- Used pdfinfo and pdftotext output from the prior PDFs to preserve the established title pattern, summary cadence, section order, validation language, file-list style, letter-size geometry, four-page shape, metadata, footer, and plain-text-readable layout.
- Ran ./read_project.sh and reviewed the refreshed cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt for the current Android source layout, drawable inventory, app/navigation surfaces, screenshot awareness, and scanner convention.
- Reviewed git status, git log, git show --stat, and the final July 24 commit 6848ccb, with context from the July 23 right-rail Variant 5 commit and earlier presentation-overlay work.
- Reviewed CinerificDestinationScreen.kt, CinerificChrome.kt, CinerificRightSideNavBar.kt, HeroPresentationTextAnimation.kt, MainActivity.kt, theme resources, and the drawable-nodpi chrome, card, and hero assets involved in the July 24 pass.
- Reviewed chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5.png, the accepted right-side nav rail resource, and chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5_landscape.png, the user-supplied rotated landscape companion asset.
- Reviewed screenshots and user feedback showing the top-banner center artifact, the overly dark fallback top image, the requested right-rail visual source, and the need to crop rather than stretch the landscape asset.
- Reviewed Android runtime evidence from adb, emulator, launchctl, lsof, AVD files, and Android Studio / VS Code state to diagnose why the Cinerific_Standard_Tablet AVD was difficult to boot and locate during the day.

Baseline Status Before July 24 Work

- Cinerific entered July 24 with the Home/default hero presentation overlay accepted, the four July 23 reel-derived titles present in Home, Movies, Shows, and detail surfaces, and the right-side navigation rail using the Figma Variant 5 black/purple background.
- The Android system UI had already been darkened from the July 23 pass, but the tablet AVD was being difficult to run in a predictable standalone or editor-visible state.
- The detail hero loading path still exposed an unattractive dark-gray placeholder panel beneath the hero image while the spinner animation was active.
- Detail hero images still needed better cross-tablet behavior: presentation text should stay in the same bottom-left relative area while the hero image itself could crop at the sides or top when a tablet aspect ratio required it.
- Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings top banners still did not visually match the accepted right-side rail. The first attempt to transpose the portrait rail image into a landscape banner produced an obvious artifact near the horizontal center.
- The top-banner asset path needed the exact Variant 5 visual language without stretching the image and without reintroducing the older, darker top-bgfill treatment.

Main Goals for July 24

- Stop any running emulator instances completely when requested, then help the user launch the Cinerific AVD in a normal standalone or editor-visible state.
- Diagnose why Cinerific_Standard_Tablet was much harder to boot and inspect than the previous day, and separate tooling conflict from MacBook processing-power concerns.

- Replace the gray detail-hero loading placeholder with a blackish overlay while the spinner animation is active.
- Make detail hero imagery crop proportionally instead of stretching, preserving the relative bottom-left presentation-text area across landscape tablet aspect ratios.
- Bring the accepted right-rail Variant 5 styling into the destination top banners using a proper landscape asset, crop scaling, and no runtime distortion.
- Preserve the accepted right-side rail behavior while changing only the top-banner rendering path.
- Validate the Kotlin build, refresh the project snapshot, and produce the July 24 PDF worklog in the same style as the prior artifacts.

Work Completed - AVD Diagnosis and Runtime Recovery

- Stopped the active emulator path when the user asked to stop it from running anywhere, then checked adb devices, emulator processes, emulator locks, and port ownership rather than assuming Android Studio itself was the problem.
- Identified a hidden launchd job named com.prahlincinerific.vscode-emulator that was starting Cinerific_Standard_Tablet in a docked/headless-oriented path with -no-window, -no-snapshot-load, -no-snapshot-save, -grpc 8554, and verbose emulator flags.
- Explained that this job could reserve emulator ports, leave the AVD looking absent from Android Studio, and conflict with later attempts to open the same device as a standalone visible emulator.
- Unloaded and stopped the launchd job, then confirmed that adb devices was empty and that the expected emulator process was no longer occupying the device connection path.
- Checked that the issue did not point to MacBook processing power: the observed failure mode was tool ownership and headless launch state rather than CPU/GPU incapacity.
- Recommended avoiding simultaneous docked-emulator and standalone-emulator owners for the same AVD, and called out that scripts or README notes would help prevent the same lock/port confusion later.
- Guided the user toward Android Studio / VS Code ways of opening the AVD, while preserving the option to run the tablet emulator as a standalone visible window outside editor tabs.

Work Completed - Detail Hero Loading and Scaling

- Replaced the unattractive gray placeholder visible under detail hero imagery while the spinner animation was active with a black loading scrim that reads as intentional Cinerific darkness rather than a mismatched gray card.
- Kept the loading overlay scoped to the hero-loading interval so the black scrim appears while the spinner is animating and then gives way to the resolved hero artwork.
- Introduced a detail loading scrim maximum alpha value of 0.68, giving the loading state a blackish cover without turning the hero area into a flat solid block.
- Changed detail hero rendering away from FillBounds stretching and toward proportional Crop behavior with top-start alignment, letting the image crop where needed instead of distorting across landscape tablet aspect ratios.
- Preserved the presentation text as the visual priority: the text remains in the same bottom-left relative area while right, left, and top image edges are allowed to clip if a tablet shape demands it.
- Used repeated AVD navigation to the same card/detail route so the user could inspect the hero load, miss it, repeat it, and confirm the black loading treatment when it appeared clearly.

Work Completed - Destination Top-Banner Chrome

- Attempted to carry the accepted right-side rail visual language into Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings top banners, as requested, while accounting for the top banner being landscape and the rail being portrait.
- The first rotated/flipped portrait-asset attempt exposed an obvious center artifact. The cause was the portrait rail asset itself: its internal vertical luminance and purple structure became a horizontal-banner midline/center feature when mapped into a different orientation.
- Explained that the artifact was not a random renderer glitch; it came from reusing a portrait composition whose visual weight was designed for a tall narrow rail, then forcing that content into a wide top-banner role.
- Rejected the darker fallback top image after the user pointed out that it looked like the old asset and was too dark compared with the accepted right-rail Variant 5 appearance.
- Adopted chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5_landscape.png, which the user added as the rotated landscape companion to the right-side Variant 5 asset.

- Updated destination top bars to reference `chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5_landscape` directly instead of rotating or flipping at runtime.
- Rendered the top-banner chrome with `ContentScale.Crop` so the asset scales proportionally and crops excess edges instead of stretching to fill the destination top-bar bounds.
- Kept the right-side nav rail on its existing accepted background path so the rail could continue using its portrait-oriented Variant 5 resource while only the top bars switched to the landscape companion.

Work Completed - Commit and Handoff

- Recommended a concise past-tense commit message with a one-line header and bullets matching the actual final source scope.
- Committed the final implementation as 6848ccb on main with the header Fixed destination top-banner chrome rendering.
- Recorded in the commit body that the top bars used the new `chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5_landscape` asset, crop-scaled rather than stretched, removed runtime rotate/flip behavior, preserved the right rail, and kept the hero loading scrim/detail crop improvements.
- Refreshed `cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` after the source and asset work so the project scanner view matched the current tree for this July 24 worklog pass.
- Generated this July 24 PDF after reading all prior worklogs and matching the existing naming, section order, density, and four-page daily-log format.

Validation and Checks Performed

- Ran `./gradlew :app:compileDebugKotlin` during the July 24 changes; the Kotlin debug compilation passed after the detail and chrome rendering updates.
- Ran `./read_project.sh` before producing this PDF; it regenerated `cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt` at the repository root.
- Used `git status --short`, `git log --oneline --decorate`, and `git show --stat` to verify the source scope now represented by HEAD 6848ccb.
- Confirmed that the final source changes were concentrated in `CinerificChrome.kt`, `CinerificDestinationScreen.kt`, the Variant 5 chrome assets, and the refreshed project snapshot.
- Checked the top-banner asset path and final commit details to verify the landscape asset was used directly rather than through runtime rotation or horizontal stretching.
- Used `adb`, emulator process checks, port checks, and `launchctl` inspection while diagnosing the AVD visibility/boot issue, including the hidden `com.prahlincinerific.vscodemulator.launchd` job.
- Used repeated live emulator navigation and screenshot-based feedback to iterate the detail hero loading treatment and destination top-banner visuals before committing.
- Used `pdftinfo` and `pdftotext` on the existing worklogs before producing this artifact, then generated the July 24 PDF with the same letter-size, metadata, footer, and text-extractable style.

Files Touched During July 24

- `app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificChrome.kt`: added a `contentScale` parameter to the shared chrome background helper so top banners can crop proportionally while existing callers keep their default behavior.
- `app/src/main/java/com/prahlin/cinerific/ui/CinerificDestinationScreen.kt`: changed detail hero loading to use a black scrim, changed detail hero images to proportional crop/top-start behavior, and wired destination top bars to the landscape Variant 5 chrome asset with crop scaling.
- `app/src/main/res/drawable-nodpi/chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5.png`: remained the accepted right-side nav rail visual source and was preserved for the portrait rail path.
- `app/src/main/res/drawable-nodpi/chrome_nav_bgfill_figma_variant5_landscape.png`: added the user-prepared landscape companion asset for Movies, Shows, Favorites, and Settings top-banner chrome.
- `cinerific_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt`: refreshed by `./read_project.sh` during the July 24 project-review and worklog pass.
- `cinerific_worklog_july 24.pdf`: this generated daily worklog artifact at the repository root.

Follow-Up Context

- The AVD trouble should be treated as an ownership problem until proven otherwise: do not let a background `launchd` / VS Code docked path and a visible standalone Android Studio path compete for `Cinerific_Standard_Tablet`.

- A future helper script should expose clear stop, diagnose, and standalone-start commands for the Cinerific AVD, including adb disconnect/kill-server checks, emulator lock/port checks, and launchd-job status.
- A short README note should warn that the docked Android emulator extension can reserve the same AVD invisibly through gRPC/headless flags, making the visible emulator look missing or stuck at waiting for connection.
- The destination top-banner chrome now uses the landscape asset with crop behavior. Final visual tuning, if needed, should adjust alignment or asset crop only after inspecting the AVD on the target tablet shape.
- The detail hero presentation text is now protected from image distortion by letting hero imagery crop instead of stretch. Additional tablet aspect-ratio checks should verify the bottom-left text area on each supported landscape size.
- Generated snapshots, PDFs, and screenshots remain project-management artifacts unless explicitly committed. The accepted July 24 source state is on main through HEAD 6848ccb, while this PDF records the daily worklog state.

Output Artifact

- Filename: cinerific_worklog_july 24.pdf
- Created at the repository root in /Users/prahlin/gh/cinerific.
- Follows the Cinerific filename convention established by cinerific_worklog_july 12.pdf and continued by the July 14, July 15, July 16, July 18, July 19, July 20, July 22, and July 23 artifacts, including the space before the day number.
- Follows the established Alla Vostra/Prahlín/Cinerific daily worklog structure while keeping the body content specific to Cinerific work completed on Friday, July 24, 2026.
- No external PDF dependency was installed; this artifact was generated with a small standard-library PDF writer in the same plain-text-readable spirit as the prior Cinerific worklogs.
- Created this daily worklog PDF: cinerific_worklog_july 24.pdf.